

ACLS

ACLS N/A

Hold **\$183.92 ▼ 1.93%** 12M Price Target **\$195.00** 52-Week Range **\$65.00 – \$193.78**

Market Cap
\$5.65B

ACLS: Ripping Higher, But Getting Stretched Up Here

WHAT'S CHANGED

- ACLS pulled back a bit today (-1.93%) but it's still sitting near 52-week highs — the stock has basically doubled off last year's lows and is at 92% of its yearly range.
- A "Golden Cross" signal flashed earlier this month (when the 50-day average price crosses above the 200-day average — traders read that as bullish momentum), and options traders have been unusually active, suggesting big money is positioning for more upside.

IMPLICATIONS

ACLS makes ion implantation equipment for chipmakers — especially for silicon carbide chips used in EVs and power applications. The stock's massive run tells you the market thinks the chip equipment cycle is turning back up. But here's the catch: at \$184, a lot of that good news is already priced in, so from here you really need actual orders and revenue to keep pace with the enthusiasm. Today's small dip is normal profit-taking after a huge run, not a red flag.

VALUATION

At ~\$5.65B market cap on roughly \$870M in expected revenue, investors are paying about \$6.50 for every \$1 of sales — reasonable for a semi-cap equipment maker but no longer the bargain it was at \$65. On earnings, it's trading around 38x forward earnings (you're paying \$38 for every \$1 of profit they'll make next year), which is full-priced versus peers like AMAT and LRCX in the 20-25x range. I see maybe 5-10% upside near-term but real risk of a 15-20% pullback if the broader semi trade cools.

KEY RISKS

- Silicon carbide demand is tied to EV growth — if Tesla, BYD, and the auto guys slow their EV ramps, ACLS's biggest growth driver stalls.
- Customer concentration: a handful of big chip foundries drive most of their orders, so losing one is a real hit.
- That weird 1.1% institutional ownership number looks suspicious (most semi names are 70%+ institution-owned) — likely a data glitch, but worth flagging. If real, it means the stock is mostly retail-driven and could be more volatile than it looks.

RECENT NEWS

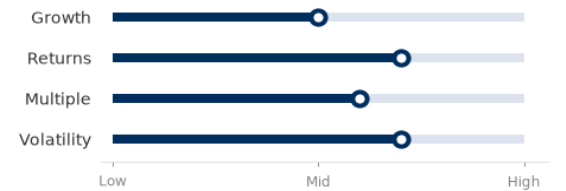
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Key Data

Price (USD)	\$183.92
12M Price Target	\$195.00
Upside / (Downside)	+6.0%
Market Cap	\$5.65B
FY2026E Revenue	\$870M
FY2027E Revenue	\$980M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.85
FY2027E EPS	\$5.90
Fwd P/E	37.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$205.00	\$188.00	\$170.00
6 Months	\$230.00	\$195.00	\$155.00
1 Year	\$250.00	\$205.00	\$140.00
2 Years	\$290.00	\$230.00	\$130.00
5 Years	\$400.00	\$280.00	\$120.00
10 Years	\$600.00	\$380.00	\$100.00

SECTOR INTELLIGENCE

HEATING UP: Technology (+3.98% over 5 days) and Industrials are the clear winners — money is flowing into anything tied to AI, chips, and capex spending.

COOLING OFF: Energy got smoked (-6% in 5 days), Real Estate and Healthcare also weak as rates stay sticky.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating out of defensive sectors (utilities, healthcare, real estate) into cyclical tech and industrials — investors are betting the economy stays strong and the chip cycle has more room to run.

RELATED PLAY: If the semi-equipment rally has legs, the bigger names (AMAT, LRCX, KLAC) usually move together with ACLS. ONTO and Kulicke & Soffa (KLIC) are smaller peers worth a look as second-derivative plays.

OUTPERFORMERS & PEER CONTEXT

- AMAT (Applied Materials): Riding the broader chip equipment wave, benefiting from AI-driven capex and leading-edge demand.
- LRCX (Lam Research): Memory chip recovery is finally happening, and they're the main beneficiary as DRAM/NAND prices firm up.

ACLS CONTEXT: ACLS has actually LED its peers off the lows — tripling while the big names "only" doubled. That outperformance is exactly why I'd be cautious adding here; it's overdue for a breather.

INVESTMENT STRATEGY

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-3% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$160-170 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-18 months

Thesis Invalidation: Silicon carbide/EV demand softens further or backlog shrinks two quarters in a row

Hedging: Pair with short on a richer-multiple semi-cap name like AMAT or LRCX